
The Odd

Written by FrogOffJury & Zentas

Abstract

Welcome another *Into the Odd* hack that is tuned for the Realm of The Odd, a patch of land around a lake that until recently had exactly zero mountains in the middle of it. With the addition of Magic, Injuries, and Quirks, it became its own system that deserves its own little rulebook. Great inspirations are taken from *Mythic Bastionland*, *Tales from Elsewhere*, *Blades in the Dark*, *Daggerheart* and *Darkest Dungeon*.

Life in the Realm of The Odd

TODO: describe things that are well known about this realm.

Getting Started

Find a Referee, create a knight, decide if they are a mage, a witch, or neither, and go for it.

Dice Rolls

To resolve some events, a roll is needed. Two mechanics modify the roll itself or the dice in the roll.

Upface & Downface. Certain abilities can Upface and Downface a die. To Upface a die, find it in the sequence:

d1, d4, d6, d8, d12

And replace it with the next one. To Downface a die, replace it with the previous one. d1 can't be Downfaced and d12 can't be Upfaced.

You probably don't have a d1 in your possession, but as it always rolls 1, you can use any small object to represent it.

When you are Upfacing or Downfacing a die in an Attack roll, do that before declaring Focus usage.

Repeated advantage & disadvantage. There are several types of rolls: attack roll, Virtue Saves, Spellweaving Roll, and more. Some of them, including the named three, can be rolled with Advantage or Disadvantage.

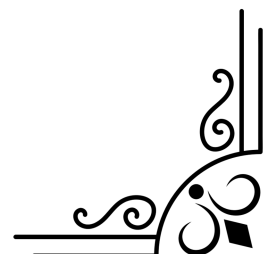
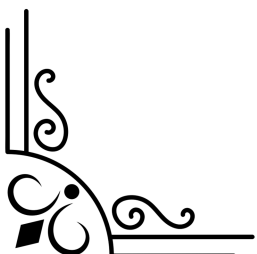
To roll with Advantage, add a copy of a die that already exists in the roll. Perform a roll and then remove a die that shares the number of faces with the added one. Typically, you want to remove the lowest one, but ultimately it's for you to decide which one to remove.

It is possible to roll with repeated Advantage by adding and then removing the corresponding number of dice copies.

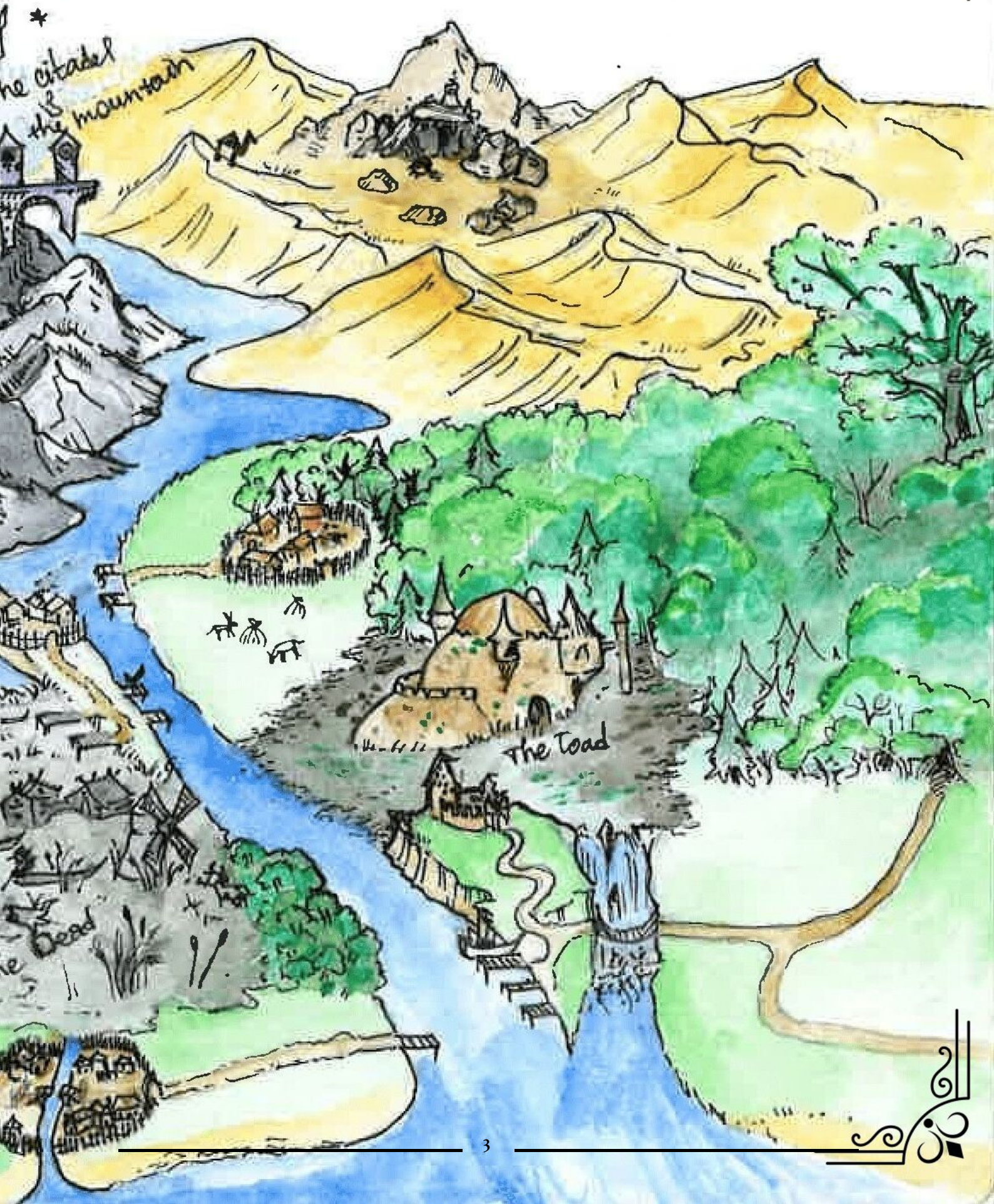
To roll with Disadvantage – do the same, but you must remove the best one (the least one for Virtue Saves, the highest for Attack Rolls) from the roll.

If there is a need to simultaneously roll with Advantage and Disadvantage, remove matching pairs of "-antages" until only one of them remains.

It is possible to add (Dis)Advantage to rolls after the roll is performed. To do that, choose a die that is present there and roll its copy. Then proceed as if they were rolled together.







Creating a Knight

Virtues

Each knight has three attributes that describe his body, mind, and soul.

Vigor. Strong limbs, firm hands, powerful lungs.

Clarity. Keen instinct, lucid mind, shrewd eyes.

Spirit. Charming tongue, iron will, fierce heart.

Knight's creation starts by rolling d6 + d12 four times; record not only the sum, but also individual values of each die. Each of those rolls determines one of the knight's Virtues; you choose which is which and discard the remaining one. You can use the character sheet on page 5.

Then, determine the knight's capacity for Injury(Injury Slots), Focus and Stress according to the steps below.

♥ Half, rounded up, of d12 you assigned to Vigor is the amount of Severe Injuries the knight can survive before dying.

† Half, rounded up, of d6 you assigned to Vigor is the amount of Lethal Injuries the knight can survive before dying.

* The value of d6 you assigned to Clarity is maximum Focus the knight has.

❖ Half, rounded up, of d12 you assigned to Spirit is maximum Stress the knight can endure before suffering a Trauma, minimum is 2.

Guard. Roll d6 to determine the maximum Guard(GD) the knight has.

Choose a Passion. Something dear to the knight's heart, or something weird that allows them to shrug off a failure. Indulging a Passion restores Spirit and Spellweaving dice (p.12). Consult with your Referee if in doubt.

Saves. To pass a Save, roll a d20 equal to or below the relevant Virtue. Failure means negative consequences, not always a failed action.

Feats. Knight knows all three Feats: Smite, Focus and Deny. They can perform them during combat, details of which are on page 7.

Injury Slots

When a knight suffers an Injury, fill an Injury slot following the steps described below.

1. Determine if injury is Severe or Lethal
2. Briefly describe an injury
3. Record the damage die of the attack which caused the injury
4. Roll Affliction(see p.8) and record it

Each injury could be:

- **Untreated** injury applies Affliction(p.8)
- **Treated**(p.7, 10) injury occupies the slot, but does not apply Affliction
- **Healed** injury is removed entirely, but leaves a Quirk(p.20) behind.

If a knight suffers an injury and all corresponding slots are full, fill one with greater lethality. If they are out of those, the knight is **Slain**.

Spellcasting

The Realm is not strange to magic and, though not frequently, knights employ it during their endeavours. Some knights are **Spellweavers**(see p.12) and some are **Witches**(see p.14). If you choose neither consider **Martial traits**(p. 9)

Weapons & Gear

When picking gear for a knight, consult with the Referee, but the rule of thumb is as follows: you have a budget of 12 points; these points can be spent on weapons and armour.

Weapon costs as much as its damage dice. For example, shortsword(2d6 damage) costs 12 points, knife(d6 damage) - 6 points. Each piece of gear providing armour costs 2 per armour point, e.g. a shield costs 6 points. Usually it makes sense to limit starting equipment(p.11) to be common rarity with a single uncommon item as a prized possession of your knight.

Name: _____

Armour

Weapons & Gear

Vigor

Guard

half or more

Lethal

4 to half

Scar if unchanged

Clarity

Focus

Spirit

Stress

Fatigue

Quirks & Malady

Ability

Witchcraft

Patron passion & Boons

Favours

Spellweaving

Spellweaving Pool

Spells

Severe Injuries

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

Lethal Injuries

Blackout until treated

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

	Treated	Injury:
	Damage Die	
		

Basic Rules

Focus & Stress

There are two important resources each knight has: the amount of thought they can put into perfecting a task and the amount of effort they can put into a failed task to fix it. Those are tracked by Focus and Stress, respectively.

Focus. Before a roll is performed, if it can be affected by a character, they can spend Focus to enhance it. It **must** be declared **before** rolling the dice. For each point of Focus spent – add Advantage to that roll.

One can not only plot how to enhance the roll, but also how to sabotage a roll. If one character can affect the roll of another destructively by planning in advance, for each Focus spent, the roll accumulates Disadvantage. *Defense* governs this interaction for the attack rolls; see below.

Usually, a knight has no restriction on how much Focus they can spend to enhance an action, but determining how much focus is possible to spend to oppose a given action should be discussed with the Referee.

Stress. After a roll is made, a knight can try to improve it by acquiring Stress. For each gained Stress, add Advantage to that roll. Increasing one's Stress **must** be done **after** the roll.

Akin to Focus, one can also acquire Stress to oppose an action after the roll is made.

Dealing with an explicit incoming danger – any amount of Stress can be spent. For a split-second reaction, like avoiding a sudden fall or dodging an arrow – up to 1 Stress can be spent.

A character can't spend Stress if they are at full Stress.

Mental breakdown happens when Stress is full after roll is resolved.

1. Reduce Stress by 1
2. Lose d6 Spirit
3. Suffer **Trauma**(p.8)

If the action is contested by Focus or Stress, opposing characters reveal how much they spend simultaneously for each.

Attacks

Turn is enough time to Move and then perform an action: attack or gambit, always in that order.

To attack – take the Weapon Dice noted on your weapon(s), shield, and granted by bonuses and go through the steps below.

1. Declare and spend Focus, if target allocated any Focus for its *Defense* – they may spend it. Remove matching (Dis)Advantages.
2. Those attacking the same target roll at the same time. Don't mix the dice: Focus and Stress apply individually.
3. Remove extra dice added through Focus.
4. Declare Stress gain. Target declares their Stress gain. Remove matching (Dis)Advantages and roll added dice.
5. Remove extra dice from Stress.
6. Now you can mix all dice and declare which one is used as a damage die and which are spent on Gambits.
7. If the target or their nearby allies can Deny, they may use it.
8. Resolve Gambits that may result in more damage dice(e.g. Dismount).
9. If the damage die is discarded – assign a new one, possibly cancelling a Gambit. Other Gambit allocations can't change.
10. Add any extra Damage from attackers who are Bolstering the Attack.
11. Subtract the target's total Armour score.
12. The Attack causes that much Damage.
13. Resolve non-damaging Gambits.

Impaired attacks roll d4 only and cannot gain bonus dice or benefit from Feats.

Blast attacks target everybody in their area, rolling each separately.

Defense is declared at the end of the turn. Allocate any amount of Focus; when you are attacked next turn, you can spend any amount of Hope (p.9) or allocated Focus to apply Disadvantage to the attack. At the end of that turn, mark all that Focus as spent.

Combat

Damage

The attack's Damage is split between the target's Guard and their Vigor at the target's discretion; both are reduced by the respective amount.

If their Vigor is unchanged – they evade the Attack.

If damage overflows into their Vigor – they are Wounded.

Check if Damage to Vigor causes a Scar or an Injury, see p.8.

If it does cause an Injury – fill the Injury slot, record damage die that dealt it and apply Affliction, also see p.8.

If a knight is injured and has no required injury slot left, they are **Slain**.

Virtue loss.

Victims are only **Slain**, Wounded or Injured if the Virtue was reduced by Damage, never as a result of *Virtue Loss*.

At 0 Vigor you are Exhausted and cannot Attack if you have moved this turn.

At 0 Clarity you are Exposed and treated as having 0 Guard.

At 0 Spirit your attacks are Impaired.

Feats

These special actions known by knights can be performed as described below. Using Feats risks the knight becoming Fatigued, which prevents them from using further Feats until they rest.

Smite. *Release your righteous fury*

- Use before rolling a melee Attack.
- The Attack gains either +1d12 or Blast.
- Pass Vigor save or become Fatigued.

Focus. *Create an opening to exploit*

- Use after rolling an Attack.
- Perform a Gambit without using a die.
- Pass Clarity save or become Fatigued.

Deny. *Rebuff an attack before it lands*

- Use after an Attack roll against you or an ally within arm's reach.
- Discard one Attack die from the roll.
- Pass Spirit save or become Fatigued.

Gambits

Attackers can discard any number of dice in Attack Roll with value 4 or higher to perform Gambits, each one causing one of the effects below. The affected foe must be the same as the target of the attack, except for the Makeshift treatment Gambit.

For gambits other than Bolster, Step Back, Move and Makeshift treatment, the target receives a Vigor Save to ignore the effect.

- **Bolster** the Attack for +1 total Damage
- **Move** after the Attack, even if you already moved or are unable to move
- **Repel** a foe away from you
- **Stop** a foe from moving next turn
- **Impair** a weapon on their next turn
- **Trap** a shield until your next turn
- **Dismount** a foe (add d6 to damage dice)
- **Step back** keeping defense up (+1 GD)
- **Makeshift treatment** of your or an ally's injury within arm's reach.
- **Other effect** of a similar level of impact

If a die of 8 or higher is used in melee, then a Strong Gambit is performed, and the attacker chooses one of the following:

- **No Save** is granted to the target
- **Greater effect** such as disarming an item, breaking a wooden shield, or removing a helm. *Bolster* and *Step Back* are not affected.

Makeshift treatment Gambit allows one knight to tend to another one, or one knight to tend to themselves. The tending knight rolls a Clarity Save, and the one untended Injury becomes tended. If that save fails, the targeted knight must survive the pain of misjudged treatment by passing a Vigor Save. If this one also fails, the injury is still treated, but increases in lethality, potentially killing the knight.

Death. Even the boldest Knight can die a sudden or ignoble death. Prepare yourself for this. When a Knight dies, the player creates a new Knight, and they are added to the Company as quickly as possible.

Lasting damage

Scars

Once a knight sustains Damage to Vigor that does not reduce their GD, they gain a Scar. Roll the damage die again, add the number of your occupied injury slots, and see the table below.

Roll	Scar
1	A lucky escape, Lose d6 Spirit.
2	An old wound opens. One injury becomes untreated again. If your max GD is 2 or less, increase it by d6.
3	A sudden pain demands attention, Lose 1 Focus.
4	Pain drowns the senses, Lose d6 Clarity. If your max GD is 4 or less, increase it by d6.
5	Something wrong on the inside. Gain 1 Stress.
6	Gruesome vision of torn flesh, Lose 2 Focus. If your max GD is 6 or less, increase it by d6.
7	A heavy blow numbs the mind, Lose 2d6 Clarity.
8	Something taken in violent struggle, Gain 2 Stress. When you get patched up, if your max GD is 8 or less, increase it by d6.
9	With a crack, a torturous break, Lose 2d6 Spirit.
10	A limb rendered useless for combat. If your max GD is 10 or less, increase it by d6.
11	Death hunts you. Gain 4 Stress.
12	A most dolorous stroke. When you achieve revenge, if your max GD is 12 or less, increase it by d6.
13+	A spiral of death makes another turn. Gain one Severe Injury.

Injuries

A knight's body is tough and trained since childhood, but it can endure only so much. Dice that determine a knight's Vigor also control the amount of Severe and Lethal Injuries they can sustain. To track those injuries, use Injury Slots that record the nature of the Injury, the damage die that caused it, and its Affliction. Injury persists until healed (p.10)

Damage from the Attack causes at most one Injury; see below, and one more can come from gaining a Scar.

♥ If a knight lost from 4 to half of their remaining Vigor through Damage – take a Severe Injury.

† If a knight lost half or more of their remaining Vigor – take a Lethal Injury.

If injury is **Lethal** – knight falls unconscious until treated.

Each untreated Severe Injury comes with Affliction according to the table below.

Roll d4	Affliction
1	The cut is deep, you are Bleeding: lose 1 Vigor when your turn starts
2	Pain is unbearable, you are in Agony: lose 1 Clarity when your turn starts
3	Grievous wound, you are in Distress: lose 1 Spirit when your turn starts
4	Luck is on your side: no Affliction.

For Lethal Injuries you lose 1d4 of corresponding virtue instead of 1.

Trauma

When Stress reaches the limit a knight can sustain, it causes Trauma: a footprint of a great effort in the form of a mental wound. Trauma fills an Injury slot and kills the knight by a heart attack if they are out of them. It has neither damage die nor Affliction and is dealt with in its own way (p.10)

Battle Flow & Martial Prowess

The battle rages as much on the field as in the warrior's mind. Extinguishing fear and tending to dwindling hope is as important as finding weaknesses in the enemy's armour.

Also, it's rare that knights fight alone.

Tracking NPC state

Usually, non-player characters (NPCs), and especially those who are not knights, are tracked with less granularity than those controlled by players. Main stats that are not tracked are Injuries and Stress: for bookkeeping and get-out-of-jail nature, respectively.

Instead of tracking Injuries, each time an NPC takes Vigor damage that is half, rounding up, of their remaining Vigor – they blackout. They die if left untreated for a while.

Instead of tracking Stress of hostile NPCs Referee uses Fear. The players can use Hope to do the same for knights' allies.

Fear & Hope

Fear. Each time a knight or a friendly npc rolls 1 on their weapon die or 20 on a Virtue Save the Company accumulates one point of Fear. This is a resource for the Referee, not knights.

When a hostile NPC wants to use Stress – the Referee can spend Fear of the Company instead of the NPC's Stress. NPCs don't acquire Traumas; how much it is suitable to spend is up to the Referee.

Additionally, if a knight attempts something risky – it might make sense narratively to manifest their Fear as if they were opposed by some external forces.

Fear is a property of the Company, so it is persistent across passage of time and scenes.

Hope. Each time an enemy of the Company rolls 1 on their weapon die or 20 on a Virtue Save the Company accumulates one point of Hope.

This is a resource, but this time – for the Company. Any player can use Hope for *Defense*, as Focus for themselves or as Stress for friendly NPCs. Spending Hope can't cause Trauma.

Hope is also a property of the Company, so it also persists.

Martial traits

TODO: some flavour text about trading spellcasting for combat prowess.

Fluency of Combat occasionally comes to those who never engaged with the world of magic.

During fights, you can spend your Guard to move in a strange dance of blade and fury. When deciding what dice to spend on Gambits, you can use dice with value below 4 as long as you compensate the difference by reducing your Guard.

Weapon mastery manifests when a knight develops an uncanny fascination with their weapons. They treat them not as mere tools of the craft, but as partners or trustworthy friends.

That allows them to see beyond the material, beyond the function, but towards possibilities.

Each time you roll a maximum value on a weapon die, put a mark on the weapon it belongs to. When amount of marks matches its largest weapon die – you obtain a level of mastery with this weapon.

When you use Focus or Stress and choose to duplicate the dice that belong to your weapon – for each mastery level you can keep the dice that otherwise would be discarded due to accumulated Advantages.

Weapon mastery levels do not transfer between any weapons even if they are of the same type, e.g. replacing one shortsword with another does not allow to keep the mastery level.

Riposte is a risky and potentially deadly Feat. If you choose to *Riposte*, you can use it instead of Deny Feat. Roll your weapon dice as if you are performing an attack. Spend any amount of Hope or Focus you allocated for *Defense*, keep one weapon die per point spent.

You can match any of your dice with lower dice in the attack roll against you. Deal damage equal to the sum of pairwise differences between matched dice. Discard enemy's dice that were matched. The damage of the enemy's attack after *Riposte* ignores your Guard.

Pass a Spirit save or become Fatigued.

Recovery

Breather

Guard requires only a swift moment of safety to recover.

Stress & Focus can also be dealt with quickly, but require consuming **physic**(p. II).

A knight can restore their Focus by sheer willpower. They roll d4 and lose that much Clarity. For each point of Clarity lost this way, a knight restores one point of Focus.

A knight can also reduce their Stress this way by rolling d4 and losing that much Spirit. If at least one point of Spirit was lost this way, they reduce their Stress by 1.

Short Rest

It is not enough time to make a fire and cook food, but just right to treat injuries, have a talk, or just zone out to process the latest events.

Focus is restored with limited efficiency. Each knight can restore their Focus through Short Rest, but the amount restored this way in total per day cannot exceed their maximum Focus.

Injuries can be treated during Short Rest without rolls. Knights have basic medical skills to dress and clean wounds. Mark all Injuries as Treated.

Virtue restoration during a Short Rest is possible, provided a knight has required **Remedy**(p. II).

Overnight Rest

There is no or little hospitality, just a safe place in the forest or nearby ruins. You make a tent, fire, and a meal. This is how life is sometimes.

Stress is reduced by 1 each time a knight sleeps full night, **Focus** is restored fully.

Virtues can be restored by 3 points distributed however a knight sees fit.

Long Rest

A proper rest in a bed, with a roof overhead and a hot meal in relative safety. No armour is worn; weapons are stored away. You have time to be with yourself or with those around you and

forget, at least of a little bit, about all the burdens waiting for you outside.

This takes a night, a day, and another night to have full effect.

A **single Injury** is healed without rolls during a Long Rest. Acquired **Stress** is removed. **Virtues** and **Focus** are restored fully,

Healing

Healing an Injury removes it completely. This is a tricky endeavour which usually requires a professional to accomplish and comes with a price tag.

Still, in dire circumstances, a knight can attempt to heal themselves or another knight:

1. The **healing** knight rolls a Clarity save to determine how to treat this type of Injury most effectively.
2. The **healed** knight rolls a Spirit save to see if they are able to withstand the pain.

Only if both of the above saves are successful, the knight is healed from the Injury. Any one knight can endure only 1 healing attempt per day.

Getting tougher and acquiring quirks. After suffering through the agony of medicine without painkillers, a knight is relieved from an injury completely.

If the maximum Guard of a knight is less than the maximum value on a die that is marked on the Injury Slot, increase Guard by 1.

Free the Injury Slot that was occupied by the healed Injury.

Choose or make the Referee choose a Quirk (p.20) for you that is described below and permanently add it to your knight.

Dealing with Trauma removes it completely. During your sleep, pass a Clarity and a Spirit save to successfully deal with Trauma. For each point of Stress you have, treat those Virtue saves as if they were opposed with an additional Focus.

Trauma leaves a permanent mark: acquire a Quirk(p.20) as if a knight healed from an Injury.

Equipment

Weapons & Armour

Weapons have properties to reflect their behavior.

- **Hefty** weapons require one hand. Only one such item can be wielded at once.
- **Heavy** weapons require both hands
- **Long** weapons are **Heavy** and are Impaired in confined environments.
- **Slow** weapons cannot be used if the attacker has moved this turn.

Melee hefty weapons can be two-handed: add its lowest weapon die to the attack and Downface it.

Common Weapons.

- Simple tools: d6 hefty. (pitchfork, hatchet)
- Long, Slow Tools: d8 long, slow. (staff, logging axe, pick)
- Hand Weapons: d6. (dagger, club, handaxe)
- Hefty Weapons: d8 hefty. (spear, mace, axe)
- Long Weapons: d10 long. (poleaxe, billhook)
- Sling: d4 hefty
- Javelin: d6 hefty

Uncommon Weapons.

- Shortbow: d6 long, slow
- Shortsword: 2d6
- Longbow: d8 slow

Rare Weapons.

- Longsword: 2d8 hefty
- Greatsword: 2d10 long, slow
- Curvebow: 2d6 long, slow
- Crossbow: 2d8 heavy, slow

Armour. Generally, each of the three layers of armour gives an additional armour point, up to A4 with a shield. Steel protection is rare, so helms, plates and chainmail are very valuable assets.

- ✕ Coat: AI (mail, gambeson, flexible armour suitable for general wear or beneath plates)
- ✕ Helm: AI (kettle, nasal, bucket, coif)
- ✕ Steel plates: AI

Shields. Takes one hand, gives one point in armour, common to find. Does not stack if there are two shields. It has d4 as a weapon die.

Spiked shields turn that die into d6.

Consumables

Those are hard to come by and usually acquired as a favour from skilled professionals.

Remedy.

- ✦ **Sustenance** restores Vigor
- ✦ **Stimulant** restores Clarity
- ✦ **Sacrament** restores Spirit

Provide individual restoration by themselves, but can be shared with Company during Short Rest.

Physic.

- ✦ **Spur** replenishes Focus and restores up to 3 Spellweaving dice
 - ✦ **Sedative** removes Stress
- Can only be used by a single person.

Medicine.

- ✦ **Painkiller** removes Vigor save from injury treatment. Allows treatment of an additional injury today while in effect. Wears off in an hour.
- ✦ **Hallucinogen** renders the knight unable to perform basic tasks for six hours and allows them to fight all their inner demons at once. For each Trauma, they may roll a Spirit save. After each failed save, the corresponding Trauma worsens and changes the injury slot to lethal; otherwise, it's removed, and the knight receives a Quirk(p.20). Can be taken during sleep.

These also can only be used individually.

Spellweaving

Weaving a spell

The power of a mage is represented by a Spellweaving Pool: a set of dice that you can use to weave spells.

The spellweaving pool is described by

- Amount and kind of dice it can hold
- How one restores those dice
- What actions, if any, could change it

If several effects grant you a spellweaving pool, those exist independently unless specified. Consuming **Spur** refills 3 dice from any combination of pools.

To weave a spell, a weaver rolls any number of those dice from any available pools as an Action from that set and then decides what to cast. This is a Spellweaving roll. Only one spell can be cast per roll. If the spell does not state otherwise, **Smite Feat** is not applicable for attacks performed within them.

There are many spells one can learn during their mage training, but regardless of syllabus – all spellweavers know *Detect Magic* by heart.

Rethreading of the arcane

When a mage rolls dice to weave a spell, in addition to casting, they can choose half, rounded down, of the remaining dice and discard the rest. These chosen dice can be stored to cast spells later as if they are included in a roll. They persist until spent, and count as in Spellweaving Pool. The amount of dice in the pool, both unused and stored, can't exceed its size.

Becoming a spellweaver

A knight who has been taught spellweaving gets their Spellweaving Pool at character creation. They know any three spells from the list below in addition to *Detect Magic*.

- **Dice** are all d6's, and their amount is equal to the value of knights' **Clarity**.
- **Restoring** the pool is done through **Overnight Rest** or indulging a **Passion**, both methods restore 3 of the missing dice.
- **Improving** this pool is challenging; the limit of what could be thought is reached.

Spells

Detect Magic. Pick any number of dice; for each one that rolled its maximum value, you can ask a question about surrounding magic and receive a truthful answer, but the number of words in that answer can't exceed the value rolled on the die. For each other die, the answer is either yes, no, or silence if the question is not applicable. Information for the answer is provided by yourself and spells around you. For example, spells usually are not directly marked by their caster and are not aware of their surroundings beyond the spell's design.

You can learn how a spell unknown to you works. Upon discovery, do a **Clarity** save; if successful, ask the Referee if you can learn this spell and, if you can, how many times encountering this spell in the wild is enough.

Soothing Visions. Pick two dice both with the same value rolled as the target's **Stress**. Reduce their **Stress** by 2.

True Strike. Pick any number of dice, then perform an Attack as usual. You can replace any die of the attack with any die from those you picked. Can be used with **Smite Feat**.

Shield. Pick two dice and add the smaller rolled value among them to **Guard** of a willing creature nearby. The shield's **Guard** is spent before theirs. Shield's **Guard** persists until their **Guard** would be restored normally.

Haste. Pick any number of dice that amount to the target's **Vigor** or greater. Each time a hasted creature attacks, choose a weapon and add its **Weapon** dice to the Attack one additional time.

Mind Sliver. Pick any amount of dice, perform a ranged attack as if those dice are your weapon dice.

However, the damage from this spell is dealt to **Spirit** or **Clarity** instead of **Vigor**. If half or more **Virtue** is lost as a result of this spell, the target's attacks are **Impaired** until your next turn.

Helping hands. Pick any number of dice that amount to exactly ten. You summon a pair of hands to help you. You can control them directly or delegate simple tasks. Choose where they grow from; usually hips or shoulders are the best choice. Your productivity increases greatly for tasks you already know how to perform.

In combat, they can wield either *two non-Hefty* weapons or *one Hefty*. They are not very strong, so nothing heavier is feasible. You can still benefit from only one shield. They last for a task you summoned them to fulfill or for one combat. Slowly dissipate when idle.

Hex. A curse of misfortune impairs defense and makes the target more vulnerable. Pick three dice that have a value of 1. Mark them as spent, but they can't go back to the pool while the spell lasts.

For the remaining combat, anyone who attacks the bearer of this curse can add a die from the picked ones as an additional weapon die before rolling. The die is not spent and can be used by multiple attackers, but only a single Hex can be cast upon any one creature. The spell is active for a couple of days or until dismissed.

Outside of combat, any die can be used as a penalty to Virtue rolls that could be affected by luck, e.g., thoughts are generally unaffected, but physical and attention-dependent actions are.

Conjure embodiment of magic. Pick up to two dice three times; values for each pick determine virtues of the embodiment. Then pick an additional die – this is its guard. Embodiment obeys your commands and vanishes when any of its virtues reach zero. At dawn of each day, you need to maintain it: pick up to two dice; that's the new Vigor of the embodiment.

Otherwise, halve each of its virtues, rounding down. Embodiments are unnatural for this world, so at dawn, reduce its Clarity by 2. At the end of each combat, reduce its Spirit by 1. You choose the shape and overall appearance of the embodiment, but it still looks very unnatural and magical for anybody who glances at it.

It has no armour, attacks for 2d8, and can use one Feat you choose each morning. It is as intelligent as an orca, can't speak, but comprehends languages you know. Does not really understand human ways, but can mimic them with mixed results.

Magic missile. Identical glowing bolts launch towards chosen targets, piercing bone and muscle. Pick any number of dice with the same value rolled. You can pick a different target for each bolt; it deals Damage equal to the rolled value.

Heat Metal. Intricate ladder of arcane pulses rapidly heats metal until it glows red hot. Pulses should be chained together carefully; pick no less than three dice with consecutive values. If it is a piece of armour, the wearer takes Damage equal to the sum of chosen dice. If it is a weapon, the bearer chooses to drop it or persevere through pain, taking half of the sum of the chosen dice. Any Damage from this spell ignores Guard.

Blade Ward. Pick any amount of dice, mark them as spent, but they can't go back to the pool while the spell lasts.

Each time an attack would hit you for damage that is exactly equal to the value of any picked dice, treat the attack as if it was evaded. Discard the matching die. The spell persists until dismissed or all dice are spent.

Witchcraft

Witches cast spells as manifestations of favors granted to them by their patrons. Favour is spent after a spell is complete and is regained when a witch indulges the passions of their patrons.

Cantrips don't cost favor, but stop working when a witch has none.

A witch can commune with their patron at will as long as their favour is not zero. Generally, a patron is helpful, but pursues their own goals and struggles to understand human ways outside of their domain. Favour determines how many times a witch can request an audience and expect an answer.

Thaliat, a laughing spirit

Thaliat's passion is of laughter, festivals, and theater. She craves stories and tales. Enjoys performances that are done out of pure heart. Treasures celebrations that bring sincere joy for those who participate.

Cantrips

- **Prestidigitation**, a nothing spell. Sparkles, small lights, whispering sounds, change of colour. The more inconsequential something is, the more probable it is a shape of Prestidigitation.
- **Mending**, a minor repair spell. Fixes a tear in fabric, crack in leather, or a snapped thread.

1 Favour spells

- **Last call bell**. You start a dance, a trick, or any other performance. As long as you are doing it, all doors to the room you are in, except maybe one, close and lock themselves.
- **Curtain drop**. You bow down as if you just ended a performance. Smoke or water mist envelopes you for a few seconds, giving you and up to one other person near you an opportunity to escape combat.
- **Invisible helper**. You summon an invisible, almost immaterial creature that obeys your mental commands. It can move and carry objects that a determined child can; it is easily scared of violence and likes sweets. Disappears when you fall unconscious.

- **Failed Rehearsal**. When you fail a Spirit Save or Clarity Save, you can immediately retry it. Each save can benefit from this spell only once.
- **Disguise Voice**. Make your voice appear as somebody else's whom you heard within at least one conversation.

2 Favour spells

- **Am I here, am I there**. Suddenly it is very hard to understand where you are and what you are doing. Anybody who looks at you feels confused and puzzled, unable to understand your intentions. In combat, it means that for the remainder of it, when you Deny – an additional die of your choice is discarded.
- **Cursed Joke**. You tell your vilest joke and sprinkle enough magic to take it inside the target's head. Upon hearing it, target retracts themselves from any conversation they were having or any activity they were doing. Goes to the corner or seeks solitude if the corner is unavailable and sits there in an increasingly catatonic state. The target falls unconscious after 10 minutes; when woken up, the effect ends. Their memory preserves a feeling of unpleasantness, but the content of the joke vanishes. If the target is in combat, their Attacks are Impaired until the effect ends.

3 Favour spells

- **Let me try one more time**. When you fail a Save targeted by *Failed Rehearsal*, you can retry one more time.
- **All doors are open for me**. Opens any non-magically locked door
- **You are an actor too**. For an hour or until harmed, the target thinks that they are somebody else **they** have a strong impression of. The target acts according to their own understanding of that entity. Upon recovery, they remember vaguely what happened during the effect of this spell.

Vesna, the passage guardian

Deep forest is her domain, where she guards gates between our world and the world of the dead. She seeks to guide those who are stuck in between. Gives her blessings if one helps a scared soul to complete their journey. Cares for both people and animals alike. Despises cruelty and sometimes plays with children, who can still see her. Knows about improper burials and rewards those who make peace with the dead.

Cantrips

- You travel through forests as fast as a horse rider would travel on a road.
- **I help, you provide** You sense local distress of the wilderness. When you resolve it, you can ask for something in return. If it could be found here, it's gonna be provided to you.

1 Favour Spells.

- **Be not afraid.** Talk with animals: they understand you; you understand them.
- **Tell me your story.** Talk with the dead, provided you have something they owned
- **Forest, obscure me.** As long as there is enough foliage around, it shifts to provide cover, making you and maybe one of those with you almost impossible to find.
- **I've never said that I am done.** You move fast, and your weapon moves almost on its own. For the remainder of the combat, each time you Attack, you can do an additional Gambit without expending a die.
- **Vesna guides you.** Choose a willing creature; next time they attempt a roll with at least 1 Focus – they roll as if an additional Focus was spent.

2 Favour Spells.

- **Grow my beloved, grow.** You put a new life into potentially dead vegetation with your touch. It grows very fast and obeys your commands. Branches can grapple your enemies, fix objects, and obstruct passage. Without water and soil, it dies soon after you leave, expending all its resources. For example, it takes 10 minutes to make a wooden door frame impassable, but only several seconds to make a wooden door impossible to open. In combat, it immobilizes enemies on the

round of casting and impairs weapons until escape(Vigor Save) on later turns.

- **It hurts, I know.** Transfer a Trauma from one willing creature to another willing creature of roughly the same consciousness level.
- **They are within reach.** When you search for somebody you know, you can determine if this person is dead or alive and peek into their thoughts and emotions.

3 Favour Spells.

- **There is only a single path.** When you go through a door, you envision another door that you have traversed in the past day by non-magical means. As long as you hold the door open, it leads to the place the door you envisioned leads to.
- **Look, we are alike.** You touch a willing animal and assume some of its traits: talons, fins, teeth, fur, etc. You choose what suits you best. You can share these traits with somebody if you keep physical skin contact with them for the whole time. Effect lasts until dismissed.
- **Let me take all the pain.** You touch a willing creature and transfer any one of their Injuries to yourself.

4 Favour Spells.

- **You and me: friends.** You summon an animal to aid you. It understands you when you speak with it, can't speak back, but can transmit emotions and follow simple instructions. You can choose any size as long as it is no larger than a well-fed barn cat. Depending on the size, roll for Vigor. Roll 1d1 if it's tiny, like a mouse; 1d4 for a bird, like an owl; 2d4 for a badger or opossum; d8 for a cat or a small dog. Roll d6 for Clarity and Spirit. Roll d4 for Guard. If it dies, you can summon it again after sunset. Its natural weapons allow it to attack for a d4 damage. It can perform *Bolster*, *Impair*, *Move* and *Stop* gambits. It has one Severe injury slot.

Aestur, the ravaging spirit

In the beginning there were stillness and staleness. The sky and the earth were solid and flat and iron. The light didn't travel through space but was preserved frozen in one place, and nothing was seen or heard, and nobody was looking and listening. The cosmos got bored of itself.

But even in constant there is a change. A curious atom came into being under the iron sky. It ran and played along the iron folds and collided and fell and gained velocity until the iron started to ring and sing.

And there was a great ramble and great fire. The iron earth collided with the iron sky. Aestus, the ravaging spirit, was born. The havoc ensorcelled it, and Aestus became determined to destroy. With great power, it broke off a mace out of the iron plane and went on a rampage through the universe.

And there were many things born in destruction. Light and sound, sand and water, fire and stars were the sparks of the great rumble. They were destroyed by Aestus in their turn.

But nothing was sufficient to satiate the ravaging spirit. He took a handful of dirt and made beasts, fish and people, who suffered being tossed and crushed.

By now we live, but soon comes the day we perish under the iron mace of the Aestur. No will be spared.

Each time you roll maximum on your weapon die gain one favour for each point of damage that reduced targets Vigor.

Cantrips

- **No, you can't have that.** You crush a small non-living object just outside of your reach. The force you impose is enough to snap anything you can snap with your one hand.
- Any time you would attack while having one hand free of the weapon. You can summon a Mace of Aestur for the attack. It's a **Hefty** d6 weapon. You can spend any amount of favor, upface the Mace's weapon die for each spent.

1 Favour Spell

- **Let this iron eat your flesh.** From a piece of iron you touch splits a rough, razor-sharp splinter with jagged edges. You fling it for d6 damage. If you rolled 6 on this damage die, you can discard it. In that case you choose either: to mortally wound(p.9) your victim or deliver one Severe Injury or execute one Strong Gambit.
- **Remember your fears.** Let the presence of Aestur posses you for a split second to project power and rage around. That intimidates the everybody who is near you. Treat the Spirit roll target makes to resist you as if it is opposed with 1 additional Stress. In combat, treat next incoming attack as if you allocated an additional Focus to your *Defense*(p.6) for each attacker.

2 Favour Spell

- **Hear me.** You clap your hands with deafening clang of metal. This is a melee attack with d4 Blast damage dice. Those in immediate vicinity of you who did not expect that do Spirit save and have their attacks impaired if failed. The sound can be heard from **very** far.
- **This is mine now.** Turn a non-living palm-sized object you touch into solid pure iron. Fine details can't be preserved, e.g. lock will stop working if you alter it like that, but cracks and imperfections vanish. If you throw this object as a ranged attack it has 2d4 weapon dice.

3 Favour Spell

- **Your staff is broken.** Crush a non-living object you can clearly see. Enough to destroy wooden shields and weapon handles. Not enough to destroy bricks and stone, but enough to send their shrapnel flying with 2d4 Blast weapon dice originating from the object.

Corrust, a spirit of dwindling

Sed commodo posuere pede. Mauris ut est. Ut quis purus. Sed ac odio. Sed vehicula hendrerit sem. Duis non odio. Morbi ut dui. Sed accumsan risus eget odio. In hac habitasse platea dictumst. Pellentesque non elit. Fusce sed justo eu urna porta tincidunt. Mauris felis odio, sollicitudin sed, volutpat a, ornare ac, erat. Morbi quis dolor. Donec pellentesque, erat ac sagittis semper, nunc dui lobortis purus, quis congue purus metus ultricies tellus. Proin et quam. Class aptent taciti sociosqu ad litora torquent per conubia nostra, per inceptos hymenaeos. Praesent sapien turpis, fermentum vel, eleifend faucibus, vehicula eu, lacus.

Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Donec odio elit, dictum in, hendrerit sit amet, egestas sed, leo. Praesent feugiat sapien aliquet odio. Integer vitae justo. Aliquam vestibulum fringilla lorem. Sed neque lectus, consectetur at, consectetur sed, eleifend ac, lectus. Nulla facilisi. Pellentesque eget lectus. Proin eu metus. Sed porttitor. In hac habitasse platea dictumst. Suspendisse eu lectus. Ut mi mi, lacinia sit amet, placerat et, mollis vitae, dui. Sed ante tellus, tristique ut, iaculis eu, malesuada ac, dui. Mauris nibh leo, facilisis non, adipiscing quis, ultrices a, dui.

Sickness & Malady

Venomous Snakebite

There is no antivenom. The only way to survive is to ask a mage for a concoction. They will provide it, but the treatment warps the body to assume enough features for poison resistance to take hold. Those changes are irreversible.

Your pupils might turn vertical, scale to appear in places where new skin would have grown.

One can find additions to internal mouth structure or lower back growths.

- Once per combat, you spit venom out of your mouth. It is quick and unexpected: add a d8 to your weapon dice.
- Shape of your head slightly changes, so you can't wear rigid headwear if its not custom made for you.

Mocking Sickness

Once, when wounded, you witness that there is no flesh and no blood inside you.

In its place you find only crumbling clay, withered fabric, and sawdust. However, despite all the differences, you feel the same. Maybe a bit duller to the touch and less pain. At last, you notice that your wounds are not healing.

- You don't lose Vigor. Since you discover this change in yourself, record Damage you receive that would have been subtracted from your Vigor.
- For each 3 points of Damage accumulated this way treat your maximum Vigor as if it is reduced by 1. When it reaches 0, your body loses structural integrity and dissolves to dust.
- You accumulate Injuries based on Damage received and wither away when you are out of Injury slots.
- You can kinda feel how your insides should be arranged and don't feel much pain, so you can mend yourself from two Injuries during one Long Rest without rolls.

If you find a puppet master that will agree to such an outstanding demand, they could try to patch your body to restore its former shape, reducing the recorded Damage.

Bloating Infection

Your wound is infected, and at some point in your fever-induced delirium you met a foreign presence. It asked you to receive a gift.

The fever was gone in a day. Your recovery amazed anybody who has ever seen an infected wound like yours.

You feel the tint of that presence in each movement of your limbs, in each twitch of a muscle, in each breath and sip of water. Numbness, slowness, swelling of legs and arms. Your skin never recovered its natural colour; your chest and stomach bloat, your breathing becomes sluggish, with unsettling rocking in your lungs.

You move with visible delay, and your reaction is impaired. When injured – you feel neither pain nor distress.

- Each time you do Overnight Rest if your max GD is greater than 1 reduce it by 2.
- For each 2 Guard lost this way increase your maximum Vigor by 1, up to 19.
- You ignore Afflictions of Injuries.

Weaving Parasite

Parasite awakes and digs into your body. You feel a flash of agony, and then it's gone. Unnatural motions of muscles and skin are the only evidence of where it is. In a day, it reaches your brain and hatches. You can sense more of the arcane than ever before: learn the *Detect Magic* spell.

However, thoughts become murky, and your mind drowns in fog. You lose 1 maximum Clarity and now have a Spellweaving Pool with a size of 1 filled with a single d4.

- Each morning you must feed the parasite. After waking up, roll a die from your Spellweaving Pool, lose that much Clarity. Restore 1 spent die from the pool.
- Record total amount of Clarity lost this way. For each 5 Clarity lost – lose 1 maximum Clarity, increase pool size by 1 and add an additional d4 to the pool. Permanently Upface it once for each other die in the pool.
- When you have a d12 added this way – parasite is fully matured and stops feeding.

Detached Soul

When your body takes critical damage, instead of succumbing to injuries and pain, your soul detaches and continues to fight.

- When you can't allocate a new Injury, you don't die. Instead, your body collapses, and your ghostly form emerges.
- It has 1 Vigor, 0 Armour, but otherwise keeps your parameters. Physical Damage applies to you the same, but targets Spirit instead of Vigor and ignores armour.
- You keep your Traumas, but not Injuries. For damage to Spirit, do the same Injury calculations as for Vigor, but receive Trauma instead. If you can't fit a new Trauma – you are **Slain**.
- You can't be grappled, pushed, or moved, and you can't do the same to interact with objects. So, you can't perform Gambits that require physical interaction. However, you can Bolster just fine.
- You deal damage to Spirit and you can give Trauma if you would have dealt enough damage to cause an Injury. Additionally, ignore armour for Injury and damage calculations.
- You can't use Deny Feat, but gain ability to go through physical objects. There is no limit, but when there is no light, you can lose sense of direction and become trapped.
- If your physical body dies – you persist, but it's easier to return to your own mortal vessel than to find a new one. There are no obvious ways to do either, though.

You can choose the appearance of your soul and keep two pieces of your gear and one weapon.

Particular Brain Damage

There was a lucky sword strike or a very violent night out. After waking up, you realise that the world is different from what you remember. Learn the *Detect Magic* spell.

You gain a Spellweaving Pool with two d4 in it. Each time you reach maximum Clarity, roll the maximum die in your Spellweaving Pool and lose that much Clarity. You may permanently Upface one die in your Spellweaving Pool.

Split Personality

Your mind overloads with stress; you feel like insanity approaches, but instead of collapsing into the abyss – your consciousness splits, and now you are not just one, but two.

You create another knight that from now on inhabits your body.

- Roll three d12 + d6 and pick two of them and assign to Clarity and Spirit. Determine values of Focus and Stress for your new personality and track these separately from the old ones.
- Decide if they are a Spellweaver, a Witch or neither.
- Both of you still share Vigor, Injury Slots with their contents and Guard.
- Both of you acquire Quirks independently, share corporal illnesses, and must switch upon gaining Trauma, which is shared between the two of you.
- You can willingly switch governing personality by acquiring 1 Stress.
- Pick their Passion and, finally, a name.

Once the splitting event occurs, you switch to the new personality immediately.

Unsettling Discovery

You can't refill any Spellweaving pool by resting or indulging a passion. If you didn't have a Spellweaving pool before, you get one.

Each time you receive damage, record the damage die. **Upface** it for each time it was Bolstered. **Downface** it for each point of damage which was reduced by Armour or did reduce Guard instead of Vigor.

Add this die to any of your Spellweaving pools. You add this die even if your pool is full.

Learn the *Detect Magic* spell.

Quirks

Bloodlust. A visceral reaction to blood fuels strength, but lessens control. You can Upface one die of your weapon if you are Wounded(p.7). However, if somebody is wounded, you can't engage them with nonlethal force.

Desensitized. The things you saw made everything else bleak in comparison; you don't feel much ever since. When you treat an injury on the battlefield, you roll with an additional Focus. However, you can't treat yourself.

Thick-skinned. After you recover, your skin changes. It became rougher and harder to pierce. You ignore the first Damage to your Vigor per combat if it is not larger than 2. However, when your injury is treated on the battlefield, the roll is treated as if it is opposed with an additional Focus.

High pain tolerance. Your body seems determined to never let you suffer again. You can ignore up to one Agony consequence of your injury. However, each time you roll a 20 on a Vigor Save, you lose 1 Vigor.

Masochistic. Pain is unbearable, but somehow it's a good thing. You regain all Focus each time you suffer an Injury. However, don't recover Focus during Short Rest.

Blade obsession. At the beginning of each day, randomly determine a weapon you own that you are obsessed with. You can Upface any die of that weapon. However, each time you strike, you must strike with the weapon you are obsessed with. You can't part with it; during combat it must be in your hand, otherwise at arms length at most.

Gore fascination. You ignore Distress afflictions of your Injuries. However, you must treat your Injuries by yourself.

Stressjunkie. Each time you gain Stress, also gain Focus. However, your maximum Stress is halved, rounded up. It can't go lower than 1.

Sadistic. Restore one Focus each time an Attack you participate in reduces both Vigor and Guard. However, gain one Stress when an attack you participate in does not reduce the target's Vigor. If this point of Stress would cause Trauma, gain no Stress instead.

Smile like no other. You don't smile a lot, but when you do, people feel what you have been through. You can Downface any die that is used in an Attack against you. However, whenever you take a Clarity save during socialization, treat it as if it was opposed with one additional Focus.

Traumatic visions. Each time you swing at your enemy, pain returns. You can keep it at bay, but it takes effort and willpower you don't always have to spare. Each time you roll with Focus, you can Upface one die before choosing what die to copy. However, each time you roll without Focus – Downface one die in your roll.

Overconfident. For some reason, after all the pain, you feel like you have figured it all out. Each time you perform a Feat – gain one Focus after the attack. However, each time you are Fatigued – lose 2 Spirit.

You never learned. Record each time you are Fatigued. Each third time, reset the count, resist the Fatigue and gain 2 Stress.

Strength in suffering. When you attack, upface a die if you have at least one Injury Slot filled with active Affliction.

Forgotten Spells

Remnants of the Great Hand

These are spells that once were written in the Book of Gaub¹, but as hand's power dwindled – they were lost to time.

The one on the pulse. To cast a curse, fill a leather bag with rusty nails and put something with corporeal traces of the victim in it. Pick one die. It is locked within a spell while it lasts. In order for curse to complete the victim must touch the prepared bag.

You can, at any time, exploit the curse as a spell. Pick one die, shake the bag, roll the die locked in the spell – victim takes that amount of damage.

The one trailing letters. Perform a ritual, it kills you, with your last dying breath you utter a word that bind itself to an object. One who interacts with the object hears your voice. You keep your personality and memories while bound. If you convince a person to perform a ritual – you possess their body, while they become bound to the object.

The one pointing the way. Bury your hands and feet under of a road, trail or passage. Pick any amount of dice. For each die which rolled its maximum value – ask a question, the answer has as many words as the value rolled. For each other die – ask a question the answer will be yes, no or silence.

The one under floorboards. You turn a hallway behind the door infinite for a duration of the spell. Anybody who enters is immediately lost even if the door is open. If group of people enters the are together as long as they can see each other. The hallway is can be just straight, but upon wish of the caster it can bend, have curves and appear finite at first.

Pick any amount of dice and calculate the sum of their values: thats how long spell lasts in hours. You can support the spell at twilight by picking more dice.

The one gnarled to the bone. Some sort of returning damage spell. You wound me, you get the wound as well.

The one that is not there. Antimemetic spell. You are unrememberable.

The one bottling tears. Put somebody in a jar? As a treat?

Blood magic

I sacrifice my flesh. You pull out a knife and with a swift motion cut your skin open. Warmth of blood and metallic smell fills you with overwhelming sensation of returning power. Roll d8 as if you attacked yourself with a knife. Pick a single die that has its rolled value equal to damage dealt. Take that much Vigor damage and restore that many spellweaving dice. This damage is dealt directly to Vigor, causes Scar and can result in an Injury.

Your body is wasted on you. Choose a target, roll d20 and add their Vigor, this value represents how hard they resist you consuming their strength. Pick any amount of dice, add them together, add your Vigor that's your drain on them. If your drain is higher than their ability to resist – they lose Vigor equal to the difference and you restore as many spellweaving dice as much Vigor was lost this way in any of your pools. If they withstand your drain – you lose Vigor equal to the difference. You can't influence the d20 roll with Focus and Stress.

Healing

¹The Book of Guab by Lost Pages